



Household records & recovery folder

Identify what you have, where protected copies live, and when your home inventory was updated.

Emergency now? Follow official instructions and leave immediately when ordered. Do not delay departure to collect papers, copy files, or photograph belongings. Call 911 for immediate danger.

BUILD THE RECORDS FOLDER

Check a category when current copies are protected and someone else in the household knows where to find them.

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| ☐ Identity and family: photo ID, passports, birth or adoption records, and household documents. | ☐ Home and vehicle: lease, title or deed, vehicle titles and registrations, and property records. |
| ☐ Insurance: current home or renters, auto, health, pet, and other policy documents. | ☐ Medical and care: cards, medication list, prescriptions, allergies, equipment, providers, and care instructions. |
| ☐ Legal: wills, trusts, powers of attorney, custody documents, and other signed records. | ☐ Tax, work, and benefits: recent tax returns, income records, and current benefit information. |
| ☐ Financial and utilities: provider names and current contact methods. Keep account details protected elsewhere. | ☐ Pets: ID, microchip details, current photos, vaccination and medical records, and care instructions. |
| ☐ Home inventory: room-by-room photos or video plus written details where useful. | |

DECIDE WHERE EACH COPY LIVES

Keep originals and backup copies in separate protected places. Use secure digital storage or storage that protects records from fire, water, and unauthorized access.

Original records are stored

Copy we can take quickly is stored

Protected off-site or digital backup is stored

Trusted person who knows how to locate the records

Backup access plan if home, power, or cell service is unavailable

Do not write a password, PIN, safe combination, full Social Security number, or full account number here.

REVIEW AND KEEP CURRENT

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| ☐ Protected copies open and are readable; expired or outdated records were replaced. | ☐ Folder was updated after household, property, health, work, insurance, or legal changes. |
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Last reviewed / next review



Make a home inventory you can use later

Photos or video capture a room quickly. Add written details for items that are hard to identify from an image.

CAPTURE THE HOME AND BELONGINGS

- ☐ Record every room and storage area that applies, including closets, cabinets, garage, attic, basement, and sheds.
- ☐ For items needing detail, record description, make, model, serial number, and purchase information you have.
- ☐ Date the inventory and keep a protected copy away from home or in secure digital storage.
- ☐ Include exterior views, outbuildings, and vehicles. Open drawers and cabinets when safe and appropriate.
- ☐ Keep existing receipts, appraisals, and supporting records with the protected inventory.
- ☐ Update after a move, renovation, major purchase, sale, or disposal.

ROOM-BY-ROOM INVENTORY CHECK

Room or area	Photos or video	Detailed items	Backup location

Inventory file or folder name 	Date recorded
Receipts, serial records, or appraisals are stored 	Next inventory update

KEEP A NEUTRAL CONTACT LOG AFTER AN EMERGENCY

Record who you contacted and the reference information they gave you. Follow each organization's current instructions. This log does not determine coverage, eligibility, deadlines, or next steps.

Date and time	Organization / contact method	Reference or information received

KEEP IT PRIVATE

A filled copy can reveal where documents and valuables are stored. Keep it with trusted household records and do not share it casually. Use with BCL emergency planning sheets at bouldercreeklocal.com/downloads.

OFFICIAL SOURCES

[Cal OES: Family Readiness Guide](#) | [CFPB: Prepare before a disaster](#)
[CFPB and FEMA: Disaster Checklist](#) | [CA Dept. of Insurance: Home inventory](#)
[IRS: Safeguard records and document valuables](#)